PAKISTAN PENAL CODE - WOMEN PROTECTION EXTRACT

Relevant sections for violence, harassment, acid attacks, forced marriage, kidnapping and forgery

Purpose

This extract lists PPC provisions most relevant to women's protection in Punjab. It is a practical index and explanation, not a replacement for the certified PPC text.

Section 294 - Obscene acts and songs

Punishes obscene acts or songs in or near a public place causing annoyance.

Section 324 - Attempted murder

Relevant where an acid attack or violent assault could have caused death.

Section 326 / 326A-326B - Dangerous hurt / acid-related provisions

Covers causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means; acid-crime provisions address throwing or administering acid with intent to injure or disfigure.

Section 337 - Hurt

General hurt provisions relevant to physical assault and injury.

Section 337E - Acid crime

Specific provisions dealing with acid attacks, punishment and related relief.

Section 375-376 - Rape and punishment

Defines rape and prescribes punishment; later amendments strengthened procedure, evidence and penalties.

Section 376A-376E - Aggravated rape-related offences

Cover gang rape, custodial rape, rape causing death and related aggravated circumstances.

Section 354 - Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty

Covers physical assault or use of force against a woman with intent to outrage her modesty.

Section 354A - Assault or use of criminal force to woman and stripping her of clothes

Covers forcibly stripping or attempting to strip a woman.

Section 354B - Vitiating atmosphere for woman

Covers conduct intended to insult or harm the dignity/safety environment of women.

Section 354C - Voyeurism

Covers watching or capturing images of a woman in a private act without consent.

Section 354D - Stalking

Covers following, contacting, monitoring or attempting to contact a woman despite clear disinterest, including electronically.

Section 365-365B - Kidnapping and abduction

Covers kidnapping/abduction, including abduction for marriage or illicit purposes.

Section 366A - Procuration of minor girl

Covers inducing or forcing a minor girl into illicit intercourse or related exploitation.

Section 366B - Importation of girl from foreign country

Covers importing a girl under 21 for illicit intercourse or related purposes.

Section 493 - Cohabitation caused by deceitful means

Covers deceiving a woman into a relationship by pretending to be her husband.

Section 494 - Bigamy

Covers marrying again during the subsistence of a lawful marriage, subject to legal exceptions.

Section 495 - Concealment of former marriage

Covers concealing a former marriage from the person with whom a subsequent marriage is contracted.

Section 496 - Marriage ceremony fraudulently gone through without lawful marriage

Covers dishonestly going through a marriage ceremony knowing no lawful marriage results.

Section 496A - Fictitious marriage ceremony

Covers dishonest or fraudulent marriage ceremonies knowing no lawful marriage results.

Section 497 - Adultery-related provision

Historic provision; legal treatment has changed through judicial interpretation and later law.

Section 498 - Enticing or taking away or detaining with criminal intent a married woman

Covers enticing, taking away or detaining a married woman with criminal intent.

Section 498A - Kidnapping or abducting woman to compel her to marry

Covers kidnapping/abducting or compelling a woman to marry any person.

Section 498B - Prohibition of forced marriage

Criminalizes coercing or compelling a woman to marry. Punishment: 3-7 years and fine up to Rs 500,000; for a girl child or non-Muslim woman, 5-10 years and fine up to Rs 1 million.

Section 506 - Criminal intimidation

Covers threats of injury, harm or other intimidation; relevant to blackmail and threats.

Section 509 - Insulting modesty / sexual harassment

Covers words, gestures or acts intended to insult modesty, sexual harassment and related intrusive conduct.

Section 499-500 - Defamation

Covers false imputations harming reputation; relevant to false accusations and humiliating posts.

Section 463-477A - Forgery and forged documents

Covers making, using or possessing forged documents; relevant to fake nikahnama, fake divorce papers, fake property documents and fraudulent transfers.

How to choose the right section

- Physical violence or acid attack: Sections 324, 326/326A-326B, 337, 337E.
- Sexual violence: Sections 375-376E.
- Public harassment, stalking, voyeurism: Sections 354, 354A-354D, 509.
- Forced, fake or fraudulent marriage: Sections 493-498B.
- Threats and blackmail: Sections 506 and 509, with PECA where online.
- Fake nikah/divorce/property documents: Sections 463-477A.